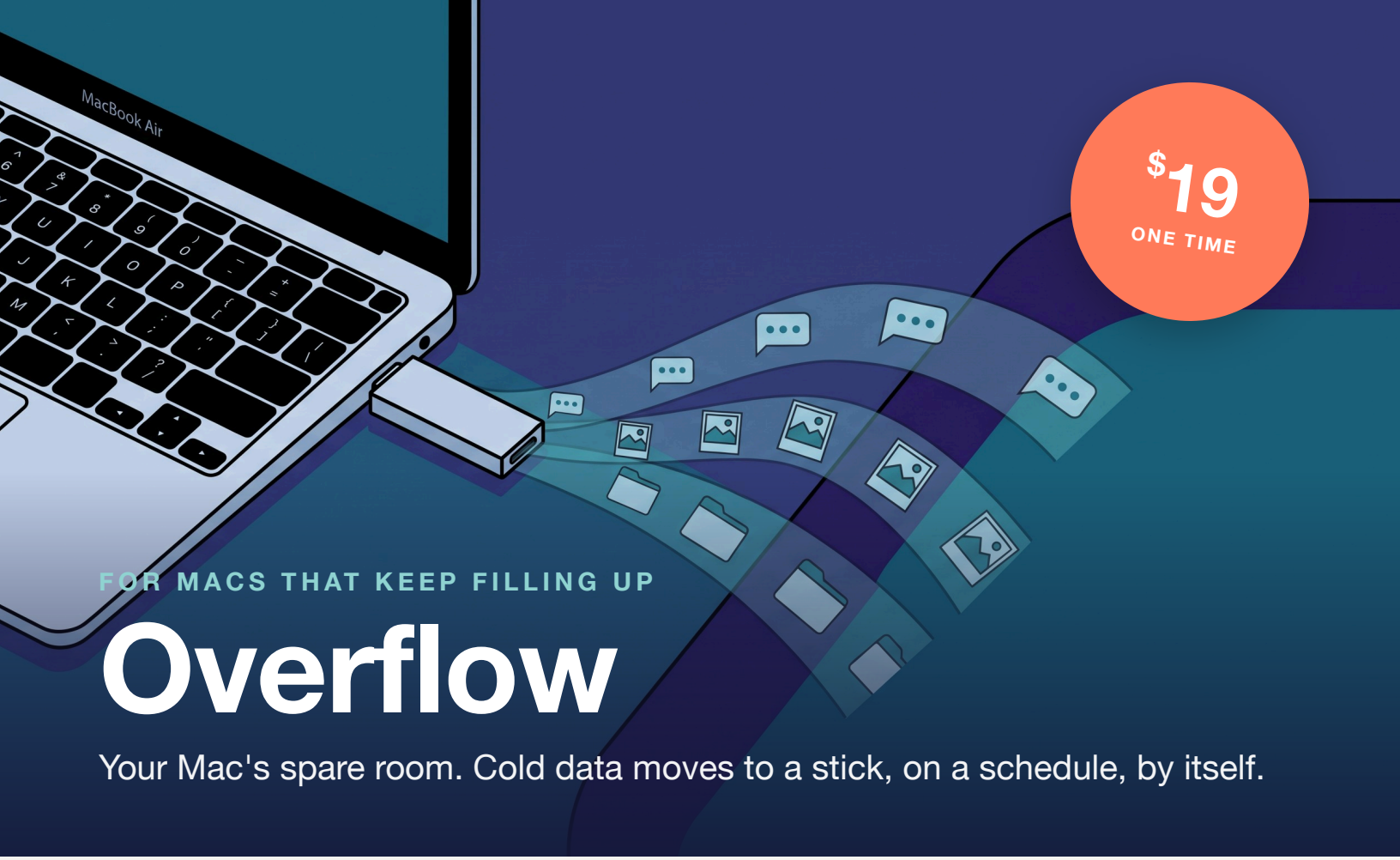


FOR MACS THAT KEEP FILLING UP

Overflow

Your Mac's spare room. Cold data moves to a stick, on a schedule, by itself.

Every AI coding session, every generated image, every one-off project copy stays on your laptop forever, until the disk is full and you're deleting things at 2 a.m. **Overflow** plugs a cheap, stays-in-the-port USB-C stick into that problem: once a week it moves whatever has gone cold to the stick, leaves a pointer behind so nothing breaks, and shows you the result in the menu bar. Nothing to remember. Nothing to babysit.

Runs itself

A weekly job finds files and folders that nobody has touched in weeks and moves them off the internal disk. If the stick isn't plugged in, it quietly skips.

Nothing breaks

Moved folders leave a symlink at the old path. Your tools keep working. Every file is copied and byte-verified before the original is removed.

Lives in the menu bar

Free space next to the clock, turning orange and red as it gets low. One click to preview or run an archive, open the log, or eject the stick.

Average first run: 20 GB off the laptop in under 15 minutes.

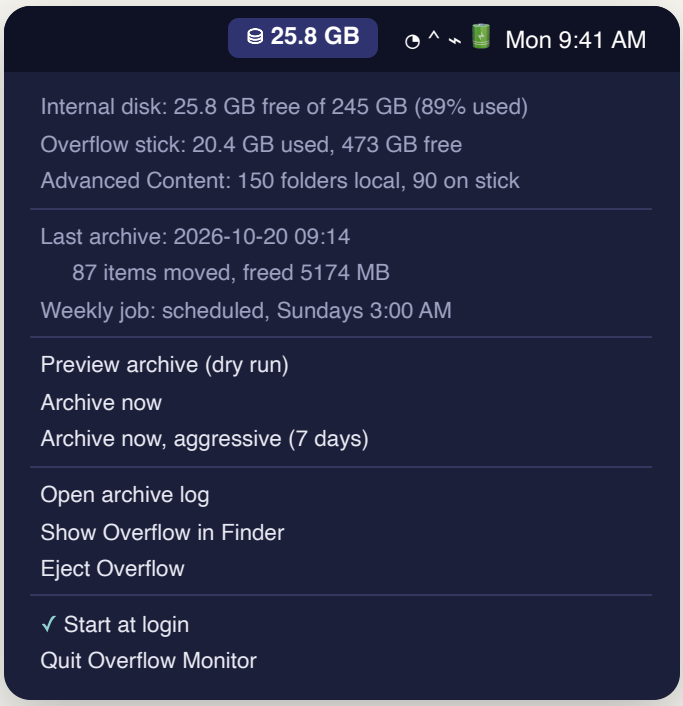
Native Swift app, 4 files, no dependencies. Works with any USB-C stick or SSD. macOS 13 or later.

How it works

Three sources on the laptop, one destination on the stick. Same path on both sides, so putting anything back is a plain copy.

ON THE LAPTOP		ON THE STICK `/VOLUMES/OVERFLOW`	RULE
AI session transcripts `~/.codex/sessions/…/*.jsonl` Multi-GB chat logs you'll rarely reopen	→	`.codex/sessions/…` moved file by file	**older than 30 days**
Generated images `~/.codex/generated_images/…` Every PNG a model ever drew for you	→	`.codex/generated_images/…` moved file by file	**older than 30 days**
Project task copies `~/Projects/Advanced Content/<task>/` Per-task working copies, each a full export with its own media and build output. Live git repos never move.	→	`Projects/Advanced Content/<task>/` moved whole, **symlink left behind**	**idle for 14 days** Idle = no file under 1 MB modified. Big media is ignored, so clones and copies can't fool it.

The menu, as you'll see it



Built to not lose your data

- **Marker file.** The stick carries an empty `.overflow-stick` file. No marker, no move. It can't write into an empty mount point or the wrong drive.
- **Verify, then delete.** Files are copied, compared byte for byte, then removed. Folders are checksummed with rsync. A failed check keeps the original.
- **Databases and keys stay home.** SQLite stores, settings, credentials and anything you list in `FOLDER_KEEP` are never candidates.
- **Dry run by default.** The script shows what it would do unless you pass `--run`. Everything is logged on the stick.
- **Plain files, plain paths.** No database, no proprietary format. Unplug the stick and read it on any Mac.

Install in sixty seconds

Format any stick as APFS and name it **Overflow**. Clone the repo, run the installer, pick your sources in one config file. The menu bar app, the weekly job and the archive script all land in the right places.

```
git clone https://github.com/danmarai/overflow
cd overflow && ./install.sh
# then edit, if you like:
#   ~/Library/Application Support/Overflow/config.zsh
```

Overflow $19 one-time, all future updates included
Friends & family edition: free. Bring your own stick.

Made on a 228 GB MacBook Air that was down to 262 MB free.
Not affiliated with Apple, OpenAI or SanDisk.